

Environmental assessment procedure for routine and minor works

Standard safeguards list

EIA-PO5-G01-T02

Contents

1	Introduction	2
2	Standard safeguards	2

1 Introduction

The standard safeguards are used to ensure that any routine or minor works are carried out with minimal harm to the environment. The safeguards are grouped by environmental issues. Not all safeguards will apply to every proposed activity. The project manager should consider the scope and location of the works and then use the standard safeguard list to determine which of the standard safeguards are relevant to the proposed activity being carried out. It is the responsibility of the project manager to determine which of the standard safeguards are relevant for the proposed activity and ensure that their method of implementation is included in an environmental management plan (EMP) for the works. If advice is required on identifying which safeguards apply to the works or how they are to be implemented. The project manager should consult with regional environment staff.

If relevant safeguards cannot be applied or implemented for the proposed works, further advice must be sought from regional environment staff. The project manager must consult with regional environment staff and complete the *Step 2 memo* (EIA-P05-G01-T04).

2 Standard safeguards

Table 1: Standard safeguards list.

General
G1. If the scope of the works changes at any time, review under the Roads and Maritime Services <i>Environmental assessment procedure for routine and minor works</i> (EIA-PO5-1) to determine any new measures to take. G2. An environmental management plan is prepared and implemented prior to the commencement of works. G3. No new access tracks to be created for the works. G4. Parking of vehicles and storage of plant/equipment is to occur on existing paved areas. Where this is not possible, vehicles and plant/equipment are to be kept away from environmentally sensitive areas and outside the dripline of trees. G5. Any access to waterways using barges/boats or similar is to be via an existing boat ramp with no disturbance to the bank or surrounding vegetation.
Erosion & sedimentation
E1. Erosion and sediment control measures are to be implemented and maintained to: • Prevent sediment moving off-site and sediment laden water entering any water course, drainage lines, or drain inlets. • Reduce water velocity and capture sediment on site. • Minimise the amount of material transported from site to surrounding pavement surfaces. • Divert clean water around the site. (in accordance with the Landcom/Department of Housing <i>Managing Urban Stormwater, Soils and Construction Guidelines</i> (the Blue Book)). E2. Erosion and sedimentation controls are to be checked and maintained on a regular basis (including clearing of sediment from behind barriers) and records kept and provided on request. E3. Erosion and sediment control measures are not to be removed until the works are complete and areas are stabilised.

E4. Work areas are to be stabilised progressively during the works. E5. A progressive erosion and sediment control plan is to be prepared for the works. E6. The maintenance of established stockpile sites during is to be in accordance with the RTA <i>Stockpile Site Management Procedures. 2001</i>.
Water quality
W1. There is to be no release of dirty water into drainage lines and/or waterways. W2. Visual monitoring of local water quality (ie. turbidity, hydrocarbon spills/slicks) is to be undertaken on a regular basis to identify any potential spills or deficient erosion and sediment controls. W3. Water quality control measures are to be used to prevent any materials (eg. concrete, grout, sediment etc) entering drain inlets or waterways. W4. Measures to control pollutants from stormwater and spills would be investigated and incorporated in the pavement drainage system at locations where it discharges to the receiving drainage lines. Measures aimed at reducing flow rates during rain events and potential scour would also be incorporated in the design of the pavement drainage system. W5. Potable water is used for wash down. W6. Excess debris from cleaning and washing is removed using hand tools. W7. Containment material is used to capture / filter water used in wash down.
Potential or actual acid sulphate soils
X1. Potential or actual acid sulphate soils are to be managed in accordance with the RTA's <i>Guidance for the Management of Acid Sulphate Materials 2005</i>.
Air quality
A1. Measures (including watering or covering exposed areas) are to be used to minimise or prevent air pollution and dust. A2. Works (including the spraying of paint and other materials) are not to be carried out during strong winds or in weather conditions where high levels of dust or air borne particulates are likely. A3. Vegetation or other materials are not to be burnt on site. A4. Vehicles transporting waste or other materials that may produce odours or dust are to be covered during transportation. A5. Stockpiles or areas that may generate dust are to be managed to suppress dust emissions in accordance with the RTA's <i>Stockpile Site Management Guideline (2011)</i>.
Noise and vibration
N1. Works to be carried out during normal work hours (i.e. 7am to 6pm Monday to Friday; 8am to 1pm Saturdays). Any work that is performed outside normal work hours or on Sundays or public holidays is to minimise noise impacts. N2. Noise impacts are to be minimised in accordance with Practice Note 7 in the RTA's <i>Environmental Noise Management Manual</i> and RTA's <i>Environmental fact sheet No. 2- Noise management and Night Works</i>. N3. Measures, including allowing adequate distance that rollers can come to adjacent buildings and/or using non vibrating rollers, are to be used to minimise or prevent vibration impacts.
Biodiversity
F1. There is to be no disturbance or damage to Threatened species or Critical Habitat. F2. Works are not to harm Threatened fauna (including where they inhabit bridges or other structures eg timber fence posts). F3. If unexpected threatened fauna or flora species are discovered, stop works immediately and follow the

RTA Unexpected Threatened Species Find Procedure in the RTA Biodiversity Guidelines 2011 – Guide 1 (Pre-clearing process)'. F4. Vegetation that has been protected or planted as part of offset works provided as part of an approved project (eg in association with fauna crossings) is not to be removed. F5. All pathogens (eg Chytrid, Myrtle Rust and <i>Phytophthora</i>) are to be managed in accordance with the RTA Biodiversity Guidelines - Guide 7 (Pathogen Management) and DECC Statement of Intent 1: Infection of native plants by <i>Phytophthora cinnamomi</i> (for <i>Phytophthora</i>). F6. Declared noxious weeds are to be managed according to requirements under the Noxious Weeds Act 1993. and Guide 6 (Weed Management) of the RTA Biodiversity Guidelines 2011. F7. Fauna handling must be carried out in accordance with the requirements the RTA Biodiversity Guidelines - Guide 9 (Fauna Handling). F8. Works are not to create an ongoing barrier to the movement of wildlife.
Traffic
T1. Where possible, current traffic movements and property accesses are to be maintained during the works. Any disturbance is to be minimised to prevent unnecessary traffic delays.
Non-Aboriginal heritage
H1. Works to be carried out in accordance with the approved Conservation Management Plan for the heritage item (where available). H2. If unexpected archaeological remains are uncovered during the works, all works must cease in the vicinity of the material/find and the steps in the RTA Standard Management Procedure: Unexpected Archaeological Finds must be followed. Roads and Maritime Services Senior Regional Environmental Officer must be contacted immediately. H3. If any items defined as relics under the NSW Heritage Act 1977 are uncovered during the works, all works must cease in the vicinity of the find and the Roads and Maritime Services Senior Regional Environmental Officer contacted immediately. H4. If an existing heritage item or item identified on the RTA's s.170 register is on site or in the near vicinity of the works, the item is to be protected to prevent any damage or disturbance. H5. Any painting of a heritage item is to be in the same colour scheme as that of the existing colour scheme.
Aboriginal heritage
B1. If Aboriginal heritage items are uncovered during the works, all works in the vicinity of the find must cease and the RTA's Aboriginal cultural heritage advisor and the senior regional environmental officer contacted immediately. Steps in the RTA Standard Management Procedure: Unexpected Archaeological Finds must be followed.
Waste management
M1. Lead paint materials are to be managed in accordance with the Australian Standard AS4361.1 'Guide to Lead Paint Management – Part 1 Industrial Applications 1995'. M2. Resource management hierarchy principles are to be followed: • Avoid unnecessary resource consumption as a priority. • Avoidance is followed by resource recovery (including reuse of materials, reprocessing, recycling and energy recovery). • Disposal is undertaken as a last resort. (in accordance with the Waste Avoidance & Resource Recovery Act 2001) M3. Bulk project waste (eg. fill) sent to a site not owned by the Roads and Maritime Services (excluding Office

and Environment and Heritage licensed landfills) for land disposal is to have prior formal written approval from the landowner, in accordance with RTA <i>Environmental Direction No. 20 – Legal Off-site disposal of Bulk RTA Project Wastes</i>. M4. If coal tar asphalt is identified and is to be removed, it is to be disposed of to landfill in accordance with RTA <i>Environmental Direction No.21 – Coal Tar Asphalt Handling and Disposal</i>. M5. There is to be no disposal or re-use of construction waste on to other land. M6. Waste is not to be burnt on site. M7. Waste material, other than vegetation and tree mulch, is not to be left on site once the works have been completed. M8. Working areas are to be maintained, kept free of rubbish and cleaned up at the end of each working day.
Visual amenity
V1. The use of shotcrete is to be managed in accordance with RTA's <i>Shotcrete Design Guidelines 2005</i>. V2. Landscaping is to be managed in accordance with RTA's <i>Landscape guideline, 2008</i>. V3. Noise walls are to be managed in accordance with RTA's <i>Noise wall design guidelines, 2006</i>. V4. Bridge works are to be managed in accordance with RTA's <i>Bridge aesthetics guidelines, 2003</i>. V5. Works to be carried out in accordance with EIA-N04 <i>Guidelines for visual impact assessment and landscape character assessment</i>.
Hazard and risk
R1. All fuels, chemicals and liquids are to be stored in an impervious bunded area a minimum of 50 metres away from: • Rivers, creeks or any areas of concentrated water flow. • Flooded or poorly drained areas. • Slopes above 10%. R2. Refuelling of plant and equipment is to occur in impervious bunded areas located a minimum of 50 metres from drainage lines or waterways. R3. Refuelling of plant and equipment on barges is to occur within a double-bunded area. R4. Cleaning of spray bars (or equivalent equipment) is to occur in suitable areas (e.g. not table drains) and not cause water pollution. R5. Vehicle wash down and/or cement truck washout is to occur in a designated bunded area. R6. An emergency spill kit is to be kept on site at all times. All staff are to be made aware of the location of the spill kit and trained in its use. R7. If an incident (eg spill) occurs, the RTA's <i>Environmental Incident Classification and Management Procedure</i> is to be followed and the Roads and Maritime Services Contract Manager notified as soon as practicable.
Community consultation
C1. Community consultation is to be undertaken in accordance with the RTA's <i>Community Involvement Practice Notes and Resource Manual</i>. C2. Complaints received are to be recorded and attended to promptly in accordance with the RTA's <i>Community Involvement Practice Notes and Resource Manual</i>. C3. Existing access for nearby and adjoining properties is to be maintained at all times during the works unless otherwise agreed to by the affected property owner.

About this document

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Approval and authorisation		Name
Prepared by	Environmental Officer Senior Environmental Specialist (Planning & Assessment)	Mark Woods Michelle Forwood
Approved by	Manager Environmental Planning & Assessment	Joy Duncan

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2.0	01/11/11	Additional safeguards, numbering of safeguards. Best practice updates based on user feedback.

Your comments and suggestions to improve this or any of the EIA guidelines may be sent to:

Manager Environmental Planning and Assessment
Environment Branch, Roads and Maritime Services
Level 17, 101 Miller Street
North Sydney, NSW 2060

Joy.Duncan@rta.nsw.gov.au

Ph: 8588 5735